



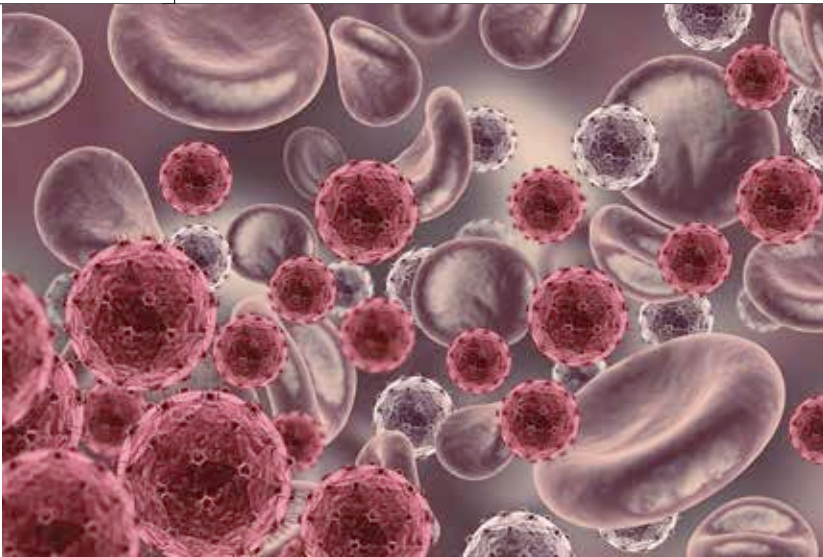
3D printing for Covid-19

3D printing unicorn Carbon is ramping up production of equipment to combat the outbreak <https://digit.in/apr20-29>



Build for Covid 19

MS, FB, Twitter and more organised a hackathon to develop tech to tackle the pandemic. <https://digit.in/apr20-30>



SILENT KILLERS

Deadly epidemics
silently trotting
the globe

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The relentless evolution of infectious diseases and their spread across the world is a major health threat to humans across the world. The recent novel coronavirus or COVID-19 has highlighted just this due to its nefarious infective nature. The first two decades of the 21st century cropped up infectious diseases that constantly reminded people how vulnerable they are to such diseases – known or unknown. Although advancements in the medical field and development of new vaccines, antibiotics, and treatments over the years may have led to a proclamation of

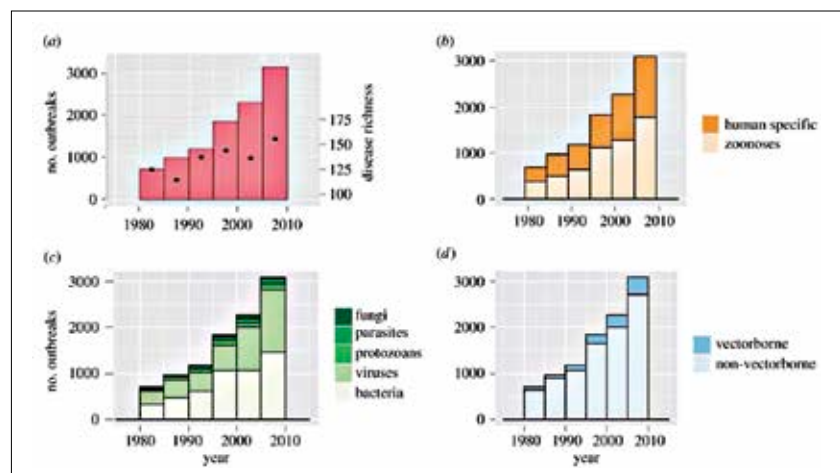
victory over threatening microbes, these microbes have always found a way to sneak back into the limelight after momentarily going out of sight.

Ebola for example, has surfaced at least 25 times in the last 40 years, according to WHO, each time as a separate and deadly outbreak, often after long spells of inactivity. In fact, a

group of researchers who charted the rise of infectious diseases from 1980 to 2010 in *The Royal Society journal* in 2014 found that outbreaks have become more common in recent decades. Today, multiple pathogens have become household names such as Ebola, MERS, SARS, Zika, Chikungunya, yellow fever and influenza, primarily due to their devastating impact in the past and even the present. However, some prevalent ones don't have a similar intensity of discourse surrounding them or have symptoms that are so understated that the deadly diseases go under the radar. Let's look at some examples of these silent killers.

HEPATITIS B AND C

Both viral infections, Hepatitis B and C attack the liver cells in the body by invading blood and other bodily fluids. The main difference between the two is that Hepatitis B, a DNA virus, is transmitted more commonly via bodily fluids while Hepatitis C, an RNA virus, usually spreads due to blood transfusion or contact. These viruses also have the ability to become chronic conditions, Hepatitis C more so, which have lasting effects. According to WHO, most of the estimated 400 million people that are currently living with chronic Hepatitis B or C don't even know they are affected. This is why hepatitis is often dubbed as a 'silent epidemic(s)'. The infection, in many cases, goes unnoticed and undiagnosed until they fester serious liver



Infectious disease outbreaks from 1980 to 2010

Source: The Royal Society